

The Australian Government made a commitment to strengthen animal welfare and increase accountability and transparency for animal welfare in livestock exports.

The Inspector-General of Live Animal Exports’ role was expanded to include animal welfare-related objectives and functions. This forms the [Inspector-General of Animal Welfare and Live Animal Exports](#) (IGAWLAE).

The Inspector-General’s responsibilities and powers are set out in the [Inspector-General of Animal Welfare and Live Animal Exports Act 2019](#).

Reviews

The department is currently addressing 48 recommendations from 8 reviews conducted by the Inspector General (various incumbents) during the period March 2020 to August 2024. 31 of the recommendations have been closed, 17 remain open. The department’s view is the remaining open recommendations are about system improvements, and none identify a critical risk or inhibit the department from meeting its core regulatory responsibilities. An overarching summary of the recommendation status for these reviews is provided in Table 1.

Table 1 Overview of Inspector General reviews and recommendation status

Inspector-General review	Date review published	# Recs1	# Recs agreed2	# Closed	# Open
Report on Monitoring and Reporting During Livestock Export Voyages	2 Mar 2020	12	12	11	1
Implementation of Moss review’s recommendations	15 Dec 2020	4	4	4	0
Review of the Exporter Supply Chain Assurance System	28 Jun 2021	8	8	2	6
Livestock export permit systems and processes	24 Nov 2021	7	7	3	4
Livestock export licences and approved arrangements	11 Oct 2022	4	4	1	3
Communication and engagement in livestock export regulation	6 Apr 2023	6	6	6	0
Implementation of Inspector-General of Live Animal Exports recommendations	20 Aug 2024	4	4	2	2
Independent Observer Program	20 Aug 2024	3	3	2	1
TOTAL	8 reviews	48	48	31	17

1 “Recs” means recommendations

2 “Agreed” means agreed or agreed in principle

The Inspector-General of Live Animal Exports made 12 recommendations in the report [Monitoring and reporting during livestock export voyages](#) (published 2 March 2020). The department agreed to six recommendations and agreed in principle to the other six. Of these, 11 recommendations have been closed.

2020 Monitoring and reporting during livestock export voyages

Recommendation	Department response	Status	Further information for open recommendations
	Agreed in principle	Closed January 2026	The department has made significant steps to improve data quality and management including:
	Agreed in principle	Closed January 2026	The department working with industry conducted trials using automated technologies during voyages including using CCTV cameras, temperature monitors, and data loggers. Following the trials the department has mandated the use of wet bulb monitors with data loggers for some voyages.
	Agreed in principle	Closed February 2021	
	Agreed in principle	Open	
	Agreed	Closed July 2026	
	Agreed	Closed April 2023	
	Agreed	Closed February 2021	
	Agreed	Closed February 2021	
	Agreed	Closed March 2023	
	Agreed		

	Closed December 2021
Agreed in principle	Closed March 2021
Agreed in principle	Closed October 2025

The Inspector-General of Live Animal Exports made 4 recommendations in the report [Implementation of Moss Review recommendations](#) (published 15 December 2020). The department agreed to three recommendations, agreed in principle to the fourth and all have been closed.

2020 Implementation of Moss Review recommendations

Recommendation	Department response	Status	Further information for open recommendations
	Agreed	Closed November 2021	
	Agreed	Closed December 2023	
	Agreed	Closed June 2023	
	Agreed in principle	Closed April 2023	

The Inspector-General of Live Animal Exports made 8 recommendations in the report [Review of the Exporter Supply Chain Assurance System](#) (28 June 2021). The department agreed to four recommendations and agreed in principle to the other four. Of these, two recommendations have been closed.

2021 Review of Exporter Supply Chain Assurance System

Recommendation	Department response	Status	Further information for open recommendations
	Agreed	Closed	Improvements to our digital foundations have been established enabling the department to make

		improvements to business facing systems and digitise services, as well as support future enhancements. Improvements include building the Export Service delivery platform, single exporter account, multiple enhancements to TRACE, and development of the Veterinary Consignment Inspection tool.
	January 2026	
Agreed in principle	Open	
Agreed in principle	Open	
Agreed in principle	Open	
Agreed in principle	Open	
	Closed	
Agreed	October 2021	
Agreed	Open	
Agreed	Open	

The Inspector-General of Live Animal Exports made 7 recommendations in the report [Livestock export permit systems and processes](#) (24 November 2021). The department agreed to four recommendations, agreed in principle to two, and for Recommendation 2, agreed to one point and agreed in principle to the other. Of these, three recommendations have been closed.

2021 Livestock export permit systems and processes

Recommendation	Department response	Status	Further information for open recommendations
	Agreed in principle	Open	
	Point 1: Agreed		
	Point 2: Agreed in principle	Open	
		Closed	
	Agreed	May 2023	

Agreed	Open
Agreed	Open

Agreed in principle	Closed January 2026	The department analysed the outcomes from a comparable trial using body cameras onboard live export vessels and determined they did not demonstrate sufficient regulatory assurances for RVOs and auditors. To support improvements to documentation processes the department has developed the Veterinary Consignment Inspection tool to record outcomes of inspections.
Agreed	Closed May 2026	

The Inspector-General of Live Animal Exports made 4 recommendations in the report [Livestock export licence and approve arrangements](#) (published 11 October 2022). The department agreed to two recommendations and agreed in principle to the other two. Of these, one recommendation has been closed.

2022 Livestock export licences and approved arrangements

Recommendation	Department response	Status	Further information for open recommendations
	Agreed	Open	
	Agreed in principle	Open	
	Agreed in principle	Closed May 2026	
	Agreed	Open	

The Inspector General of Live Animal Exports made 6 recommendations in the report [Communication and engagement in livestock export regulation](#) (6 April 2023). The department agreed to six recommendations and all have been closed.

2023 Communication and engagement in livestock export regulation

Recommendation	Department response	Status	Further information for open recommendations
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Agreed	Closed May 2026	
Agreed	Closed May 2026	
Agreed	Closed October 2025	
Agreed	Closed July 2026	
Agreed	Closed Dec 2025	The department has increased consistency across reports including aligning:
Agreed	Closed May 2026	

The Inspector General of Animal Welfare and Live Animal Exports made 4 recommendations in the report [Implementation of Inspector General of Live Animal Exports recommendations](#). The department agreed to one recommendation and agreed in principle to the other three. Of these, two recommendations have been closed.

2024 Implementation of Inspector General of Live Animal Exports recommendations

Recommendation	Department response	Status	Further information for open recommendations
	Agreed in principle	Closed October 2025	
	Agreed in principle	Open	
	Agreed in principle	Open	
	Agreed	Closed September 2025	

The Inspector General of Animal Welfare and Live Animal Exports made 3 recommendations in the report [Independent Observer Program](#). The department agreed to three recommendations and has closed two.

2024 Independent Observer Program

Recommendation	Department response	Status	Further information for open recommendations
	Agreed	Closed July 2026	
	Agreed	Open	
	Agreed	Closed July 2026	

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal-welfare/livestock-exports/igawlae>